the Durranis at Herat in the early nineteenth century brought destructive repercussions to Ghur. Cf. Ferrier (trans. Jesse) 1976: 248ff.; and note below.

17. Bamiyan has always been on one of the principal routes joining the northern and southern regions of the Hindu Kush, and also served as an administrative center west of the mountains during both the pre-Islamic and Islamic periods (A. A. Kohzad 1951a: 13; Klimburg-Salter 1989: 21; Klimburg-Salter 2008: 132; and Chapter 3). Its internal significance as well as being a major *entrepôt* on the India–Central Asia artery off the trans-Asiatic silk routes rendered it desirable for all local powers (cf. Klimberg-Salter 1989: 24), including the early Shansabanis and their collateral lineage at Bamiyan (see below in main text). Despite the great Mongol massacre at Bamiyan, however, it was *not* among the nodes of convergence of the Mongol campaigns. Cf. O'Neal 2017; Jackson 2017: 80, 158.
18. See also Thomas 2018: 39–44. The Ghuris, rather than having an endemic antipathy to outsiders, were rightly affected by the far-reaching historical ripples of the Great Game. Ferrier (trans. Jesse, 1976: 248ff.) noted that the Ghuris he encountered were extremely suspicious of outsiders, Afghan and foreigner alike, given the recent and continuing devastations unleashed on the region from Herat: in the 1830s the city had been besieged by Qajar forces under Russian guidance, while the western khanate of Herat was nominally ruled by Kamran, son of Shah Mahmud (r. at Kabul 1800–1803, 1809–1818). But his *vazir* Yar Muhammad had effectively usurped rulership from the legitimate Durrani descendant and ordered the razing of all architectural remains in the vicinity of Ghur's famous citadel of Khissar (see below in main text), out of fear that rebels and other enemies could quarter there and eventually launch attacks against Herat from the east. Cf. Dupree [1997] 2012: 343–371.
19. A. A. Kohzad 1951a: 5.
20. Cited by Thomas 2018: 52. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 328 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 318) of course first described "the natural impregnability of the strong mountains which are in Ghur."
21. In his tours of Ghur, Kohzad (1954: 64ff.) also noted that the region's southern areas boasted more abundant villages than its northern ones – understandable given that the Sistan plains were the over-wintering grounds for many nomadic populations. This is surely a long-standing socio-economic pattern, pertaining since at least the twelfth century when the Shansabanis also migrated southward for the winters. See further *infra* in main text.
22. See A. A. Kohzad (1953: 59–62); O'Neal 2016a. Certainly, in the tour reports of A. A. Kohzad (esp. 1953: 56) an intimate connection between historical Ghur and Gharjistan to its northwest seems to emerge, underscored by these regions' shared semi-sedentist populations of the Tajik Firozkohi summering there (also Jawan Shir Rasikh, pers. comm., December 2017). Indeed, modern Abdali Pashtun nomads have also migrated across the provincial boundaries between Ghur and Gharjistan (cf. Glatzer 1983: 215ff.). This strong inter-regional connection could have spanned several centuries, as hinted by the relatively early Shansabani presence in Gharjistan of the 1160s (noted *supra* in main text) and their architectural patronage of the monumental Shah-i